

Laurel Li

5252 South Cornell Ave, Chicago, IL 60615
(315) 630-2219 | zxli7@uchicago.edu

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago

Chicago, IL

B.S. in Computer Science

Relevant Coursework: System programming, Real Analysis, Discrete Mathematics, Mathematical probability, Theory of Algorithms, Machine Learning Fundamentals, Mathematical Foundations of Machine Learning, Operating systems, Programming Languages, Compilers and Programming Languages, Formal Languages, Formal Verification

PROFESSIONAL & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The University of Chicago

Chicago, IL

Advised by Professor Kexin Pei,

Feb 2024 – Present

- Conduct research on AI for software security, focusing on combining large language models with symbolic execution and fuzzing to find real-world vulnerabilities.
- Lead the development of Skopos, a framework that learns symbolic execution searchers (paper in preparation for FSE 2027).
- Co-authored Symbolon, a framework that learns diverse code transformations and applies them context-sensitively to speed up symbolic execution, improving KLEE's line coverage by 3.69x on average across 32 real-world programs and uncovering 21 previously unknown bugs in the Linux kernel (arXiv:2606.29108, paper submitted to S&P 2027).
- Contributed to Locus, an agentic predicate synthesis framework for directed fuzzing that speeds up eight state-of-the-art fuzzers by 41.6x on average and has found nine previously unpatched bugs (ICSE 2026).

EXTRACURRICULAR & LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

The University of Chicago Tech-team

Chicago, IL

Project Leader of ACII project,

May 2024

- Lead the project that aimed at combating human trafficking, child exploitation, and the distribution of child sexual abuse material (CSAM) through advanced data analysis and web crawling.
- Implemented efficient web crawling algorithms for dynamic web environments.

Understanding AI

Chicago, IL

Teaching Assistant

Jul 2026

- Held weekly office hours and worked one-on-one with students on the course material.
- Graded assignments and provided detailed written feedback.
- Instructing students on their AI security personal projects.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Technical Skills: Python, Java, C, C++, Rust, PyTorch, MATLAB, LaTeX, R, OCaml

Interests: Tennis, Pickleball, Basketball, Rowing, Sci-fi Films and Detective Fictions

Honors and Awards

- Quad Summer Undergraduate Research Scholar
- T.D. Lee Research Fellowship